

DMV Permit Prep App

Master Plan — All 51 Jurisdictions

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One engine. 51 content packs. Privacy-first. Buy-once.

The Vision

What "perfect" actually means

ONE ENGINE	Build the iOS test-prep engine once. Ship state-specific question banks as separate App Store SKUs. Florida proves the engine, then every additional state is ~1 week of content work.
PERFECT = PRINCIPLED	Three perfect features beat ten mediocre ones. Procreate Pocket model: do ONE thing extremely well, charge a fair one-time price. No bloat, no upsells, no ads.
PRIVACY IS THE WEDGE	No accounts, no cloud, no ads, no tracking. Free competitors (DMV Genie, iDriverManual) are ad-bloated and surveil users. Premium ones charge subscriptions. Buy-once \$4.99 + zero surveillance is our defensible moat.
MULTILINGUAL IS THE MOAT	California's real DMV test is in 24+ languages. Florida just removed Spanish/Creole testing on Feb 6, 2026 — bilingual STUDY app for Florida is a generational gap. No competitor handles this well.
STATE-SPECIFIC = TABLE STAKES	Real agency names (DPS in TX, MVA in MD, RMV in MA, DDS in GA, MVD in AZ — not "DMV"). Real state fines. Real local rules. No generic "permit prep" nonsense.

The Market

Why DMV permit prep is the cleanest fast win

51

US jurisdictions
(50 states + DC)

17M+

New permit/license
tests per year (US)

\$0

Question content
licensing cost (public domain)

24

Languages on
California real test

Permit testing is structurally an evergreen recurring market: every year teens turn 16, immigrants apply, license-restoration cases come back. Each US state has its own handbook (public domain government work) and its own quirky test format. The UK proves the paid app model works. The US has 50 separate state markets and effectively zero quality state-specific apps in top paid charts.

51-State Launch Strategy

Tier 1 first. Tier 2 after FL proves the engine. Tier 3 last.

Tier	States	Months	# states	Pop covered	Investment	Y1 revenue est.
Tier 1	FL → TX → CA → NY	M1–4	4	~33% of US	High content + multilingual	\$160–500K
Tier 2	PA, IL, OH, GA, NC, MI, NJ, VA, WA, AZ, MA, TN, IN, MO, MD, WI	M5–10	16	+30%	Standard content	\$80–250K
Tier 3	Remaining 31 states	M11–18	31	+30%	Lean content, English-primary	\$60–150K

Why this order? Tier 1 = highest revenue per state due to size and multilingual lift. Florida first because Shlomo lives there (ground-truth verification with real test-takers). Texas second because it is the largest Spanish-speaking market. California requires the most language work but biggest market. New York has the simplest test format (20 Qs, 70%) so fastest port.

Tier 1 — The First 4 Months

Florida ships as the master template. Each subsequent state ~1 week after.

State	Pop (M)	Test format	Languages on real test	Special situation
Florida (M1)	22.9	50 Qs / 80% pass / Class E	EN ONLY (since Feb 2026)	Bilingual STUDY app for Spanish/Creole speakers is a giant gap. State removed multilingual TEST mode but speakers still need to learn material.
Texas (M2)	30.5	30 Qs / 70% pass / 2 sections	EN, ES	DPS not DMV. Massive Hispanic/immigrant market. Adults 18-24 need ITAD course on top of test.
California (M3)	39.0	36 Qs / 83% pass	EN, ES, ZH, VI, KO, RU, AR, JA, FR, IT, PT, TL, AM, HI, KM, HY, FA, PA, TH, HE, EL, ID, IL, NE	Multilingual UI is the killer feature. Real CA test is in 24+ languages — match top 9.
New York (M4)	19.5	20 Qs / 70% pass	EN, ES, ZH, RU, KO, FR, IT, JA, PL, EL, AR, BN, UR	Easiest test format. Quickest port from engine. NYC immigrant audience.

Florida v1 — The Master Template

Get this perfect, then everything is re-skin

Week	Build	Content	Marketing	Output
1	iOS shell, onboarding, test engine, SQLite schema, StoreKit setup	Pull FLHSMV handbook (public domain). Outline 10 question categories.	Reserve App Store listing. Domain registered.	Clickable prototype + 50 questions
2	Practice mode, mock test mode, weak-area tracker, wrong-answer review	Write 250–400 questions with explanations + handbook references. Spanish + Creole study-mode translation.	TikTok account live. Plan 5 viral hooks.	Functional MVP
3	Polish, audio narration, parent/teen mode, App Store screenshots, accessibility	Accuracy review pass with 3 actual FL test-takers. Final question polish.	Landing page live with waitlist signup.	App Store-ready submission build
4	TestFlight beta, App Store submission, iterate from review feedback	Add any missed-question feedback from reviewers.	\$300 Apple Search Ads test on FL keywords. 5 TikTok videos posted.	GATE: >5% paid conversion?

Hard rule: Florida MUST hit the gate (>5% paid conversion + 4.5+ stars + 100+ installs) before Texas work begins. If FL flops, diagnose first.

One Engine, 51 Content Packs

How the same iOS app ships as 51 separate App Store SKUs

Layer	Implementation	Why this choice
Language	Swift 5.10+	Native iOS performance, accessibility, App Store trust
UI	SwiftUI	Modern, less code, better accessibility defaults
Local DB	SQLite via GRDB.swift	No servers, no accounts, lightweight, fast
Question content	JSON content packs (one per state) baked into bundle	Content updates = data update, not engineering work
Purchases	StoreKit 2	Native, no third-party SDK; one-time purchase only
Audio narration	AVSpeechSynthesizer (built-in)	No API costs, no network, supports all languages
Build	One Xcode workspace, multiple schemes (one per state)	Same engine binary, different content pack baked in
CI/CD	Fastlane lanes per state	Ship Florida with `fastlane ship_florida`, etc.
Translation	Native speakers via Upwork (\$30–60/hr)	Quality matters; machine translation kills credibility

The Feature Matrix

Three categories: Core (must), Premium (lift), Future (V2+)

Tier	Feature	Why it matters	Differentiator vs free apps?
CORE	Practice mode + mock test (state format exact)	Foundational. Match real exam exactly.	Many fake the format
CORE	Wrong-answer review with handbook references	Teaches, not just tests	YES — most skip
CORE	Audio narration (TTS)	ESL learners, dyslexia, commute studying	YES — major
CORE	Offline-first, no accounts, no tracking	Privacy positioning is THE wedge	YES — core moat
CORE	State-accurate naming + fines + laws	DPS not DMV in TX, real fine amounts	YES
CORE	Bilingual at minimum	CA needs ES; FL needs ES STUDY mode	YES — major
PREMIUM	Spaced repetition (SM-2 algorithm)	Re-tests weak areas with intelligent timing	Match Zutobi
PREMIUM	Daily streak + gamification	Habit formation, re-engagement	Match competitors
PREMIUM	Parent/teen mode	Parents are buyers; teens use	YES — most lack
PREMIUM	Multi-language UI (CA: 9+ langs)	CA real test is 24 langs; match top 9	YES — moat at scale
PREMIUM	Disability accommodations	OpenDyslexic, large text, full VoiceOver	YES — almost none
FUTURE	CDL Class A/B/C add-on	Truckers pay more	V2 — adjacent
FUTURE	Motorcycle endorsement	Riders are passionate buyers	V2 — adjacent
FUTURE	AI tutor chat (LLM-grounded)	Natural-language Q&A; handbook-grounded	V2 — none have

Pricing — One-Time Purchase Model

Buy-once. No subscription. Bundles for multi-state buyers.

SKU	Description	Price	Net (after Apple)	Notes
Per-state app (Tier 1)	FL, TX, CA, NY — full bilingual + premium	\$6.99	\$4.89	Highest content investment
Per-state app (Tier 2)	16 mid-size states	\$5.99	\$4.19	Standard tier
Per-state app (Tier 3)	All remaining 31 states	\$4.99	\$3.49	Smaller markets
Family Pack (4 users)	Household with multiple teens	\$12.99	\$9.09	Premium upsell
Multi-state bundle (any 3)	Snowbirds, recent movers	\$13.99	\$9.79	FL+NY+CA bundle = biggest
Lifetime Pro upgrade	AI tutor, audio in all langs (V2)	\$2.99 IAP	—	Optional add-on
CDL Class A/B/C	Commercial license prep (V2)	\$9.99 IAP	—	Truckers pay more
School license (B2B)	Driving school: 50 student seats/yr	\$299/yr	—	V2 recurring revenue
Spanish-only FL edition	Pure Spanish study for English test	\$7.99	\$5.59	Targeted Hispanic immigrants in FL

Apple Small Business Program: under \$1M/year revenue, Apple takes 15% (not 30%). First 18 months locked at 15%. Plan accordingly.

Distribution Playbook

TikTok > Apple Search Ads > Driving Schools > High Schools

Channel	Why it works	Tactics	Budget	Expected CPI
TikTok organic	Teens + parents are on TikTok	"Questions that trip everyone up", fail compilations, Spanish creators for TX/CA/FL	\$0	\$0
Apple Search Ads	Direct intent search → high conversion	Per-state keyword sets in EN + ES. "[State] permit test", "[State] DMV practice"	\$300–1,000/state	\$0.50–1.50
Driving school partnerships	Trust transfer + bulk sales	Free 100-student licenses for first 5 schools per state	Free inventory	\$0
High school driver-ed teachers	Teachers recommend = parents buy	Free teacher accounts. Printable lesson plans.	\$0	\$0
Reddit r/[state]	Hyperlocal authentic discussion	Genuine help in pre-test threads. Founder-named account. NO spam.	\$0	\$0
App Store Optimization (ASO)	Free organic discovery	State-specific titles, screenshots, real reviews	\$0	\$0
Spanish radio (TX/CA/FL)	Hispanic immigrant first-time-driver market huge	Drive-time radio in Houston, Dallas, LA, Miami	\$1–3K/state	\$2–4
DMV office QR code flyers	Hand out near DMV waiting rooms	Print 1,000 QR-code flyers per target city	\$50/state	~\$1
Influencer driver instructors	YouTube creators with 1M+ subs = trust	Affiliate code, 30% commission per sale	Rev share	\$0 upfront

Revenue Projection — Year 1

Conservative case across all 51 states; only Tier 1 ships in M1–4

Scenario	Conv rate	Tier 1 (4 states)	Tier 2 (16)	Tier 3 (31)	Total Net
Pessimistic	3%	\$50K	\$30K	\$20K	~\$100K
Conservative	6%	\$110K	\$70K	\$45K	~\$225K
Optimistic	10%	\$200K	\$130K	\$80K	~\$410K
Stretch (with B2B + bundles)	15%	\$320K	\$210K	\$130K	~\$660K+

Year 2 (all 51 SKUs live): \$500K–1M conservative case. Only content production scales — engine is already built. With B2B school licenses, AI tutor IAP, and CDL/motorcycle adjacencies, \$2M+ is reachable.

Cost to launch Florida v1: \$3,200 self-built (\$99 Apple + \$1,500 question writing + \$1,000 translation/review + \$300 ads + \$300 design) → \$18,500 with full freelance development.

Risk Register

Things that could kill this — ranked

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Apple rejects "DMV" naming as misleading	Medium	High	Use "[State] Driver License Practice" not "Official DMV"; read App Store Review Guidelines 5.4
Free competitors add paid no-ads tier	Medium	High	Move fast. Multilingual + privacy + buy-once = 3 moats. Lock driving-school partnerships.
State updates handbook mid-year	High	Medium	Subscribe to state DMV news. Quarterly review cycle. Push update within 30 days.
Translation accuracy issues in non-English languages	Medium	High	Native speakers, never machine translation. 5+ user reviews per language.
Competitor sues over question similarity	Low	Critical	Write all questions IN-HOUSE from public domain handbook. Document each source.
Apple Search Ads CPI spikes from competitor bids	High	Medium	Diversify channels. Don't depend on Search Ads alone.
You spread thin: ship 4 states badly vs 1 perfectly	High	High	FL must hit gate (>5% conv, 4.5+ stars) before TX work begins. Discipline.
State changes test format unexpectedly (FL English-only mandate)	Medium	Medium	Build content as data, not code. Format change = data update.

12-Month Roadmap

States live + engineering focus + decision gates

Month	States live (cumulative)	Engineering focus	Decision gate
M1	Florida	Engine v1 + FL content pack	FL >5% paid conversion?
M2	+TX (2 states)	TX bilingual port, Spanish full-test mode	TX matches FL metrics?
M3	+CA (3)	Multi-language framework (9 languages)	CA install volume?
M4	+NY (4)	NY format port (20 Qs)	Tier 1 cumulative >\$50K?
M5–6	+PA, IL, OH, GA (8)	2 states/month re-skin	Unit economics steady?
M7–8	+NC, MI, NJ, VA (12)	Arabic for MI (Dearborn)	–
M9–10	+WA, AZ, MA, TN (16)	MA = 35+ language stretch goal	Decide V2 features
M11–12	+IN, MO, MD, WI + start V2	CDL module dev begins	V2 launch decision

The Florida Goldmine

A specific opportunity unique to Florida — discovered during research

What happened: Florida switched the official driver permit test to ENGLISH ONLY on February 6, 2026. Before that, the test was available in Spanish, Haitian Creole, and other languages.

Who this affects: Florida has one of the largest Hispanic populations in the US (~5M Spanish speakers) AND the largest Haitian Creole-speaking population (~600K). These people now must learn the test material in English — but free study resources in their native language are gone with the test format change.

The opportunity — a Spanish/Creole STUDY app: Build a special FL-only edition that teaches the test material in Spanish or Creole, with the actual test-style questions in English. The user studies in their language, then practices answering in English. No competitor is doing this.

Why this is special

- Genuine vacuum created by state policy change
- Specific audience (FL Spanish/Creole speakers) reachable via WhatsApp + Spanish radio
- Higher willingness to pay than English-native users (high-stakes test, language anxiety)
- \$7.99 standalone SKU — premium positioning makes sense
- Adjacent: same model could work for any state that English-only-mandates in future

Risk

- Validate willingness-to-pay first via WhatsApp survey
- Translation must be perfect — native speaker only
- Trust factor: target audience may be skeptical of new apps
- Reach via Hispanic radio + Catholic parish networks

Pre-Launch Checklist (per state)

Run this before submitting any state to App Store. Don't skip.

Phase	Checks (must all pass)
Content	50/30/20 Q count matches actual state exam Pass score matches Real agency name (DPS/MVA/etc.) All Qs from public domain handbook 3+ FL test-takers reviewed Native-speaker translation review
Legal	No "official DMV" claim Privacy policy posted No question copied from competitor
Technical	Works fully offline (airplane mode) TTS works for all questions VoiceOver labeled Dynamic Type No analytics SDKs Tested on iPhone SE + iPad
Marketing	App Store screenshots all sizes + iPad Description clear: "no ads, no subscription, no tracking" Landing page + FAQ live TikTok 5+ videos Search Ads with negative keywords
Distribution	3+ driving schools agreed to pilot HS driver-ed teacher list r/[state] Reddit moderators contacted
Quality	TestFlight beta with 50+ users Avg rating 4.5+ stars <3 critical bugs in last week
Business	StoreKit 2 IAP tested in sandbox Refund handling tested Pricing tier validated vs competitors

What NOT to Build in v1

Resist the urge

Don't build	Why	When (if ever)
User accounts / login	Breaks privacy promise. No backend = no maintenance.	Never
Cloud sync	Forces backend ops. Adds privacy concerns.	V1.1 — opt-in CloudKit only
Push notifications	Intrusive, requires backend, easy to overdo.	V2 — local notifications only
Social features / leaderboards	Off-mission. Drives anxiety, not learning.	Never
AI tutor (LLM)	Needs backend, breaks privacy promise, costs ongoing \$.	V2 — possibly local on-device
Behind-the-wheel road test prep	Different product. Massive scope.	V2
CDL / Motorcycle modules	Different audience, different content. Stay focused.	V2
Apple Watch app	Nice-to-have, not differentiator at launch.	V2
Custom backend / server	Ops burden you don't need. App is fully local.	Maybe never
Analytics SDKs (Firebase, Mixpanel, etc.)	Breaks the privacy moat.	Never
Crash reporting third-party	Apple's TestFlight is enough.	Never

The Decision

Are you actually doing this?

If YES → first 7 days:

Day 1: Apple Developer account (\$99). Reserve **com.shlomo.dmvprep.fl**. Domain name (e.g. floridapermitprep.app or similar).

Day 2: Download FLHSMV handbook PDF. Outline 10 question categories.

Day 3: Spin up Xcode workspace. Boilerplate SwiftUI + SQLite.

Day 4–5: Test engine MVP: 50 questions hardcoded, practice/mock-test modes work.

Day 6: Hire freelance question writer on Upwork — 400 FL questions @ \$1,500 budget.

Day 7: Recruit 3 FL test-takers from your network for week 3 accuracy review.

If NO → why not?

Possible reasons to not start:

- Innexo bandwidth — your SaaS is the main asset. App is side income.
- Too crowded — DMV Genie / Zutobi / Driving-Tests have head start.
- Revenue ceiling unclear — could max at \$300K/yr not \$1M.
- You want to validate first — sign up for AppFigures/Sensor Tower entry tier (\$50–100/mo) and pull actual revenue estimates for top 3 FL competitors. If they're each doing \$200K+, market is real. If they're doing \$50K, ceiling is too low.

If validating: 1 week of research before committing 4 weeks of dev.

What You Have Now

Three deliverables to make this real

File	Contents	Use it for
dmv_app_master_plan.xlsx	10 sheets: state-by-state plan, Tier 1 launch detail, product architecture, pricing, marketing playbook, revenue projections, risk register, pre-launch checklist, 12-month roadmap	Your operating bible. Reference daily during build.
dmv_app_architecture.md	Full technical architecture: SwiftUI structure, content pack JSON schema, SQLite tables, StoreKit setup, build pipeline, Fastlane lanes, accessibility checklist, V1 definition of done	Hand to your iOS developer (or self-build reference).
dmv_master_plan_deck.pdf	This 18-slide strategic deck — vision, market, tier strategy, FL launch plan, architecture overview, pricing, marketing, revenue projection, risk register, decision framework	Share with anyone you bring in (cofounder, contractor, advisor). Read once a week to stay focused.

The discipline that matters most: Florida MUST hit the gate before Texas. >5% paid conversion, 4.5+ stars, 100+ installs in first 30 days post-launch. If FL flops, diagnose root cause before spending another week on TX. The plan compounds when each state proves the engine.